

SKYESPORTS BGMI CHAMPIONSHIP 2025 GRAND FINALS

Vasista Esports had a tournament to forget at the BGMI (Battlegrounds Mobile India) series 2025, finishing 18th among 32 teams. Before the Skyesports BGMI Championship 2025 Grand Finals, it announced a new roster, featuring captain Hector (Sohail Shaikh), Fury (Tushar Kumar), Scaryjod (Anshh) and Zin.

The change bore fruit as the side dominated the finals over three days, between May 16 and 18, finishing with three Chicken Dinners and 169 points to its name.

ESPORTS AT KHELO INDIA YOUTH GAMES

Khelo India Youth Games (KIYG) 2025 in Bihar this year saw esports played as a demonstration sport. Five titles were played at KIYG 2025 – BGMI, Street Fighter 6, Chess and eFootball, on console and on mobile – while six states took part in the event.

The host topped the medal tally with six medals (two gold, silver and bronze medals each), Maharashtra came second (one silver, three bronze), while Tamil Nadu finished third with a gold and a silver. Nagaland and Telangana bagged a gold medal each, while Arunachal finished sixth with one silver medal.

“Initiatives like these by the Sports Authority of India and the Government of Bihar reflect growing recognition for esports as a legitimate sport. This tournament has truly laid the foundation for identifying and nurturing grassroots talent,” Akshat Rathee, Co-Founder & Managing Director, NODWIN Gaming, said.



Did you know? Former Germany and Real Madrid midfielder and FIFA World Cup 2014 winner Mesut Ozil owns an esports organisation called M10 esports, established in 2018.

NESC TO PICK TEAM INDIA FOR WEC 2025 BEGINS

The Esports Federation of India (ESFI) launched National Esports Championship 2025 (NESC25) on May 14 to select the Indian team for the 17th World Esports Championships (WEC). The national qualifiers, running online from May 22, will feature top Indian athletes competing in Counter-Strike 2 (CS2) and DOTA 2. Furthermore, last year's NESC winner in eFootball will be granted a direct slot at the WEC, following the game's removal from the previous edition's line-up.

The ESFI also finalised the Indian Tekken 8 roster for the upcoming BRICS Esports Championship 2025, set to take place in Moscow from May 28 to June 3m and will see participation from China, South Africa, the UAE and Turkey among other nations.

After a double-elimination qualifier featuring 60 players from across the country, Gurashish “Soul” Singh emerged victorious, followed closely by Shubham Khorwal.

WHO AM I?

I started my career with PUBG Mobile in 2018 and was cited as a gaming inspiration at the iconic Indian TV quiz show Kaun Banega Crorepati (KBC).

The answer will be revealed in the next issue.

*Answer to previous issue's quiz:
Moin "NO_Chanc3" Ejaz*



BUSINESS OF ESPORTS

OnePlus announced its entry into Indian esports through partnerships with three gaming teams – Gods Reign, K9, and Cincinnati Kids – with an aim to expand its presence in the gaming sector.



EASTER EGG 'NOOB'

Noob (or n00b) is short for 'newbie'. It's usually used to describe a rookie player or as a banter against a losing teammate in a game.